

Philipp Hilbert. *Proxy Product Owner, Retail Banking Digital.*

Positioning, thirteen years owning backlogs and bridging business and engineering teams in regulated industries, now applying that discipline to Mashreq's retail banking digital agenda.

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Dear Hiring Team,

I am applying for the Digital Product Expert / Proxy Product Owner role within Mashreq's Retail Banking Group. With thirteen years of product ownership across regulated industries, insurance, public-sector analytics, defence AI, healthcare, and payments, I have spent most of my career doing exactly what this role describes: standing between business stakeholders and engineering squads, keeping both honest, and making sure committed backlog items actually ship.

The framing in your posting resonates with how I work. Requirements engineering, user stories, and acceptance criteria are not documentation overhead for me; they are the primary tool for reducing waste. At CLINET Platforms, I inherited a backlog a five-person team could never have delivered. I cut it to the top 10 per cent of features against agreed success measures, rewrote every remaining item to production-quality acceptance criteria, and watched user acceptance rise more than fivefold. At Rohde and Schwarz, I used the same discipline at the opposite scale, managing fifteen-plus engineers and data scientists through Scrum in Jira and Confluence on a multinational defence AI programme, and delivered a hotfix-capable GitOps pipeline that reduced rollout time from days to thirty minutes.

Your posting calls out Azure DevOps specifically, and I work in it alongside Jira depending on the organisation. The underlying discipline is identical: a backlog is only as useful as the quality of its items and the rigour of sprint planning and refinement. I bring the technical fluency to sit in an architecture discussion and the stakeholder-management practice to translate that conversation into something QA and compliance can act on.

Retail banking is a new vertical for me, and I say that plainly. What I bring is a proven pattern of landing in regulated, high-stakes delivery environments, Bundesdruckerei's secure data platform, Bundesagentur für Arbeit's national labour-market analytics, Scheidt and Bachmann's POS and payment systems, and getting to effective sprint execution within weeks rather than months. The compliance and governance instincts carry across.

I am open to relocation to Dubai and would welcome the chance to discuss how my background maps to the Injaz squad's current priorities.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*
